Today
Welcome to your next lesson: Reflection: me vs. the system.

I'm preparing your personalized lesson based on what you've already learned, what's next for you, and how you learn best.

Step by step, you're moving forward.

Ron, let's zoom in on one thing today: you vs. the social pressures around you 💭

You've already seen how people in Milgram, Asch, and Zimbardo's studies often went along with the situation. In this lesson, we'll use those to think about you: when you're likely to conform or obey, and when you might resist.

To get a feel for where you are right now, try this:

Imagine these two scenes:

Your boss tells you to do something you feel is a bit unfair to a customer.
A whole group of friends is hyped about doing something you think is a bad idea.

In your gut, which situation would be harder for you to resist in real life — the boss or the group of friends?

Just answer: boss / friends / about the same.

boss more authority over my financse

That makes a lot of sense — if someone controls your paycheck, the pressure feels heavier 💸. That connects directly to Milgram's obedience study.

Quick reminder using your boss example:

In Milgram's study, people kept giving "shocks" mostly because an authority figure in a lab coat calmly said things like "The experiment requires that you continue."

So in your "boss" case:

Authority = boss
Leverage = your finances / job
Pressure = "I might lose something important if I say no"
Let's do a tiny step with this.

When you picture that boss asking you to do something you feel is unfair, which feels like your stronger inner voice in that moment:

“I really need this job.”
“This is wrong; I don’t want to do it.”

You don’t have to explain, just pick one of those or say “honestly, it’s 50/50.”

really need the job

That’s an honest answer, and it fits what Milgram found: good people can feel trapped by authority + consequences, not by being “bad” people.

Let’s slow this down and look at one idea:

Situational pressure = what the situation is doing to you (like “this person controls my money”), not just who you are inside.

In your boss example, the big situational force is:

They control your income → threat of job loss → strong push to obey
Make this concrete for you:

If that same unfair request came from:

a random coworker (no power over your pay), do you think you’d be more likely to push back, compared to when it’s your boss?

Just answer: yes, more likely to push back / no, about the same.

Yes, more likely to push back

Right — that “yes” is a perfect example of situation > person.

Same you.

Different power dynamics.

Different behavior.

That’s exactly what the classic studies showed:

Change who has power (boss vs coworker) → obedience goes up or down
Change how many people agree (everyone vs one ally) → conformity goes up or down
Let’s do a quick recap check using your own words:

Can you give me one short sentence that starts like this:

“One situational factor that would make me more likely to go along with something I disagree with is _____.”

Fill in that blank with something real for you (like “risk of losing my job,” “everyone else agreeing,” “not wanting to look difficult,” etc.).

a situatiuon that would make me go along with something i disagee with is the person making the request has a higher status in my view, authority like a boss, experienced

trail guide on a wildenes hike for example

That’s a really clear answer, and your examples are spot on 👌

You’ve just described a key idea:

Authority / higher status as a situational force: when someone seems above you (boss, expert guide, etc.), you’re more likely to go along, even if you disagree internally.

That’s Milgram (authority) and Zimbardo (power roles) in one sentence.

Now I want to bring in a new idea: moral courage.

Very simple:

Moral courage = doing what you think is right, even when it costs you something (status, approval, comfort, maybe even money).

In your boss / wilderness guide examples, moral courage would look like:

Asking a respectful question instead of just obeying
Suggesting a safer or fairer option
Setting a limit (“I’m not comfortable doing that”)

Does that basic idea of moral courage make sense so far, in your own situations?

Yes, that makes sense

Great. Let’s connect that to something very practical for you 💡

We’ll keep this focused and concrete.

Step 1 – Pick a real type of moment

Think of a situation like this (no need to share details yet, just choose in your mind):

A boss asks you to do something you feel is unfair or not quite honest
A more experienced person (like that wilderness guide) wants to do something you feel is unsafe or wrong

Got one of those in mind?

If yes, tell me which type you picked:

“boss situation” or “experienced guide / expert situation.”

guide

Nice, let’s work with the guide / expert case 🥾🧗

We’ll keep this simple and step-by-step.

Imagine this concrete scene:

You’re on a wilderness hike.

The guide suggests a route or action that, in your gut, feels unsafe or not okay.

Two forces are fighting inside you:

Situational pressure:

“They’re the expert.”
“Everyone else seems fine with it.”
“I don’t want to be that person.”
Moral courage:

“Something feels wrong.”
“Safety / fairness matters more than going along.”
To understand you better:

In that guide situation, what would feel like the smallest realistic action you could imagine taking that shows a bit of moral courage?

Something like:

“I’d at least ask a question about safety.”
“I’d quietly pull the guide aside.”
“I’d speak up to the whole group.”
“Honestly, right now I’d probably stay quiet.”

Pick one of those, or write your own short version.

id speak up and voice my opinion

That’s a strong choice, and it’s very specific: you’d speak up and voice your opinion to the guide 🥾

Let’s slow that down and label what’s happening there.

In that moment, you’re doing two things at once:

Feeling the situational pressure

They’re the expert
Group might go along
You risk looking difficult
Using moral courage + accountability

Moral courage: “This doesn’t feel safe/right, I need to say something.”
Accountability: “If I stay silent and something happens, I’m part of the outcome.”

That second part — “I’m part of the outcome” — is what we call a sense of personal accountability.

Personal accountability = “What I choose to do or not do here matters, and I’m responsible for my part.”

Quick check-in:

In that guide scenario, which feels more true for you right now:

"If I said nothing and something bad happened, I'd feel responsible."
"I wouldn't really feel responsible; it was the guide's call."

You can just pick one of those.

I'd feel responsible

That feeling — "I'd feel responsible" — is exactly that personal accountability piece 🔍

So in your guide scenario, we can map it like this:

Situational force: expert authority + group going along
Your inner levers against it:
Moral courage → "This doesn't feel right; I should say something."
Personal accountability → "If I stay silent, I'm part of the outcome."

Those two levers are what often help people resist pressure in real life.

I'd love to connect this to your everyday life now:

Can you think of one real recent situation (work, family, friends, online, anywhere) where:

you felt pressure to go along,
but you did speak up or resist, even a little?

You don't need to write a long story — just a couple of short sentences about:

what the situation was, and
what you actually did.
had a job ercently painting lines marking underground utilities, was told to pulll aside wherever i was for a morning zoom meeting and i was on the freeway, i did speak up and said id be a few minutss late it asnt safe to pull onto a shoulder of the freeway

That's a powerful real-world example, Ron — and very clear 🚧

Let's map it:

Situation: Boss says "pull over wherever you are" for a Zoom.
Situational pressure (Milgram-style):
Authority: it's your job, your supervisor
Time pressure: "meeting is starting now"
Your response:
You spoke up: "I'll be a few minutes late; it isn't safe to pull onto the shoulder of the freeway."

That is textbook moral courage + accountability:

Moral courage: you risked being seen as late / noncompliant
Accountability: you refused to take unsafe action you'd feel responsible for
One more small reflection, then I'll check your understanding with a quick multiple choice.

In that freeway situation, which felt stronger in the moment:

"I might get in trouble for being late"
or
"I am not going to risk my safety for this"

You can just choose one.

Not risking my safety

What do you think the best answer is in the question below? 👇

In your freeway Zoom-meeting example, what BEST explains why you resisted your boss's request?

A.

Your personality makes you completely immune to authority pressure.

B.

You felt personally accountable for the safety risk and chose the morally safer option, even if it meant being a bit late.

C.

Conformity pressure from coworkers pushed you to obey without thinking.

D.

You didn't recognize your boss as an authority figure in that situation.

Exactly right ☑

You resisted your boss's request because you felt personally responsible for the safety risk and chose the morally safer option, even if it meant being late.

That shows:

Moral courage → you were willing to disappoint authority a bit
Personal accountability → "If I do this unsafe thing, that's on me"

It wasn't that you're "immune" to authority; you just had strong safety values plus a clear sense that your choice mattered.

Before we move toward wrapping this lesson up, I'd like you to do one short comparison:

Think of:

One time you went along with something you disagreed with
This freeway example, where you resisted

In 2–3 short sentences, can you tell me:

What the "go along" situation was, and
The biggest difference in what helped you resist in the freeway case but not in the other one?
had a job at walmart and a supervisor told me to switch departmens and just leave what i was doing (Stocking) which meant leaving obstacles in the aisle, i went along as he had authority and ultimate responsibility and it didnt feel it would be a huge safety factor more an annoyance. In the zoom meeting scenario i reistaed and spoke up as it was my own safety and need to not get ticketeed by a cop that pushed me to spekak up. Greater consequences

That comparison you made is sharp, Ron 🔎

You basically mapped your own life onto the classic psychology:

Walmart situation (you conformed):

Authority: supervisor had power over your role
Perceived consequences: mostly annoyance / minor safety issue
Accountability felt low: “He has ultimate responsibility”
Freeway Zoom situation (you resisted):

Authority: boss again
Perceived consequences: your physical safety + risk of a ticket
Accountability felt high: “If I pull over unsafely, that’s on me”
Result: you used moral courage and personal accountability to push back
That’s exactly the kind of reflection this lesson was aiming for: seeing how situations + your inner levers (moral courage, accountability) interact in real life, not just in textbooks like Milgram or Zimbardo.

You’ve fully hit the mastery goal for this lesson 🎓

You:

Identified real situations where you conformed vs resisted
Linked them to authority, situational pressure, moral courage, and accountability
Explained clearly why you acted differently in each case
If you ever want, we can build on this later to design “scripts” for how you’d like to respond in future high-pressure moments (with bosses, guides, or groups).

For now, nice work. You’re ready for the next lesson whenever you are — just head to Learn and continue from there 🚀